

manner that the ports such as USB, keyboard and mouse ports, and LAN ports are visible on the back of the computer tower.

5. Once you have installed the motherboard, put in the new processor (explained above) and the RAM modules. Then install the new power supply. Install the add-on cards and the IDE drives in their respective places. Now, connect the IDE cables to the back of the drives and check for the IDE connector on the motherboard to complete the connections.

Connect the IDE cable of your hard drive to the connector marked 'IDE 1' on the motherboard.

If you have more than one IDE cable that connects more than one IDE device to the motherboard, connect the other IDE cable to the connector marked 'IDE 2'. Now connect the front panel connectors to the front panel header on the motherboard. This information will be available in the motherboard manual.

If you have a motherboard that has onboard sound and video, you may have been provided with connectors for that. Refer to the manual for instructions for connecting these connectors.

Once all this is done, connect the motherboard power connector. Similarly, connect the power connectors for all other devices. Shut the case and connect the power cable to the mains, and turn on the power. Check for the display on the monitor, and listen for the POST beep, which indicates that everything is installed fine and running properly.

Check the hard drive and power LEDs on the front of the tower case. If they are lit and working properly—the HD LED blinking during read and write activity—you're done. If not, you will need to power down the machine and re-check the front panel connections.